TABLE TALKS · FREE LESSON PACK · BELOVED, REALLY

He sings over *you.*

A GUIDE FOR ONE HONEST CONVERSATION

not humming.
singing.



1 · LESSON RECAP
2 · BACK STORY
3 · TALK IT THROUGH
4 · MEMORY CARDS
5 · COLORING PAGE

"He will take great delight in you; in his love he will no longer rebuke you, but will rejoice over you with singing."

ZEPHANIAH 3:17 · NIV

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Everything for one honest conversation: the lesson, the back story, the questions, memory cards and a coloring page.

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LESSON RECAP

Most of us picture God with a red pen. Zephaniah hears Him singing.

Picture the face you imagine when God looks at you. For a lot of us it's a teacher handing back a test: pursed lips, red ink, "See me after class." Zephaniah wrote to people who had failed badly, and the last thing he heard was God rejoicing over them out loud. His delight comes first. The fixing comes later, if at all.

THE WORD ZEPHANIAH USED

rinnah

HEBREW · RIN-NAH

A ringing shout of joy. Not a hum. The sound you make when your team wins.

	The face we imagine	*The God who sings*
LOOKS LIKE	Red pen, pursed lips	Great delight
SOUNDS LIKE	"See me after class."	Singing. Out loud.
LEAVES YOU	Hiding your work	Held and at rest

> ***"The LORD your God is with you, the Mighty Warrior who saves. He will take great delight in you; in his love he will no longer rebuke you, but will rejoice over you with singing."***
>
> ZEPHANIAH 3:17 · NIV

TAKE THIS HOME

You are someone He delights in. Right now, today.

not humming. singing.

THE BACK STORY

Meanwhile, in Jerusalem, around 630 BC...

PROPHET ID CARD

Name: Zephaniah
Means: "the LORD hides" or "the LORD treasures"
Family: great-great-grandson of King Hezekiah (1:1)
Worked under: King Josiah of Judah
Book length: 3 short chapters
Known for: "the day of the LORD"

a royal kid who told the palace the truth.

What was going on

Judah had just come through 55 years under King Manasseh, who filled the land with idols (2 Kings 21). People bowed to Baal, prayed to the stars on their rooftops, and swore by the Lord and other gods in the same breath (Zephaniah 1:4-5). Faith had become a side hustle.

Into that, Zephaniah delivers some of the sternest warnings in the Bible. Chapter 1 is a storm. Chapter 2 sweeps through the nations around Judah. Chapter 3 turns the spotlight on Jerusalem itself.

Read the book like a playlist

1:1–18
The storm warning. "The day of the LORD is near."

2:1–15
The neighbors. No nation is outside God's reach.

3:1–13
Home turf. Jerusalem's leaders called out.

3:14–20
The plot twist. God sings.

Why the ending matters

After all that warning, the last thing Zephaniah records is God rejoicing over His people. He takes away their punishment, turns back their enemy, gathers the outcasts and brings them home (3:15, 19-20). The same God who saw every failure in chapter 1 is singing in chapter 3.

Under King Josiah, the nation began to turn back to God (2 Kings 22-23). Many scholars think Zephaniah's words helped stir it.

SO WHAT?

God doesn't sing over us because we got it right. He sings because we're His.

chapter 1 people get chapter 3 songs.

TALK IT THROUGH · ABOUT 45 MINUTES

Pull up a chair.

BRING
A snack, a pen and your honest self.

WHO
3 to 8 friends. "Pass" is always allowed.

TABLE RULE
What's shared here stays here.

SPARK · 5 MIN

What song makes you sing out loud in the car, no matter who's watching at the stoplight?

host goes first. off-key counts.

READ IT OUT LOUD · 5 MIN

Read **Zephaniah 3:14-17** together. Everyone listens for one word that surprises them.

QUESTIONS · 25 MIN · START LIGHT, GO DEEPER

1. When you picture God looking at you, what face do you see? Where did that picture come from?
2. Zephaniah wrote to people who had really blown it. Why do you think God ends with a song instead of a lecture?
3. "He will no longer rebuke you." Is there an old rebuke you still replay? What would it sound like to hear it end?
4. What's the difference between being *tolerated* and being *delighted in*? Where have you felt each?
5. **Deep End:** If you believed God was singing over you right now, what would you stop doing this week?

BE STILL
Five quiet minutes. Picture His delight. Just receive it.

WRITE IT
Cut out a memory card (page 4) and tape it to your mirror.

TEXT IT
Send someone here: "Remember, He's singing."

CLOSE IN PRAYER

Father, we came in picturing a red pen. Teach us to hear the singing instead. Thank You for delighting in us today, before we fix anything. Quiet the old voices and let Your love be louder. Amen.

KEEP THE JOY COMING

Get the Sunshine Mail.

One Sunday a month: Scripture, an honest reflection, and a little room for surprises.

Share your table on Instagram **@chaoticsunshinetable**.

chaoticsunshine.com

SCAN TO SIGN UP

MEMORY VERSE

"The LORD your God is with you, the Mighty Warrior who saves. He will take great delight in you; in his love he will no longer rebuke you, but will rejoice over you with singing."

ZEPHANIAH 3:17 · NIV

MIRROR CARD

He will take great *delight* in you.

ZEPHANIAH 3:17 · NIV

tape me where you get ready.

POCKET REMINDER

Remember: He's singing.

This week: five minutes of quiet. Picture His delight over you. Don't earn it. Just receive it.

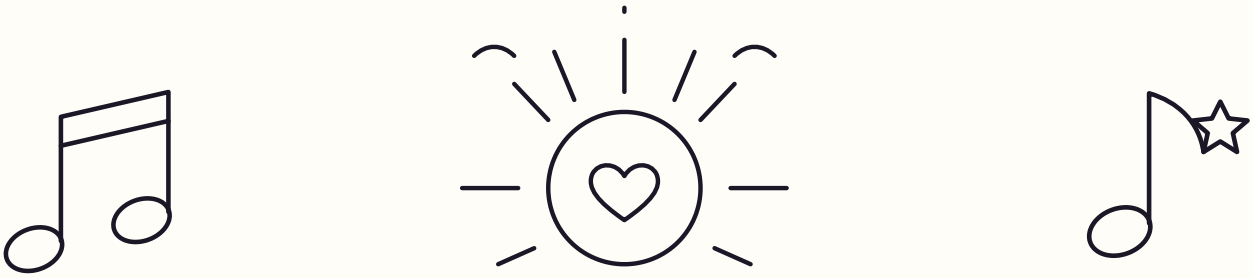
not humming. singing.

COLOR ME

He will take great *delight* in you

ZEPHANIAH 3:17 · NIV

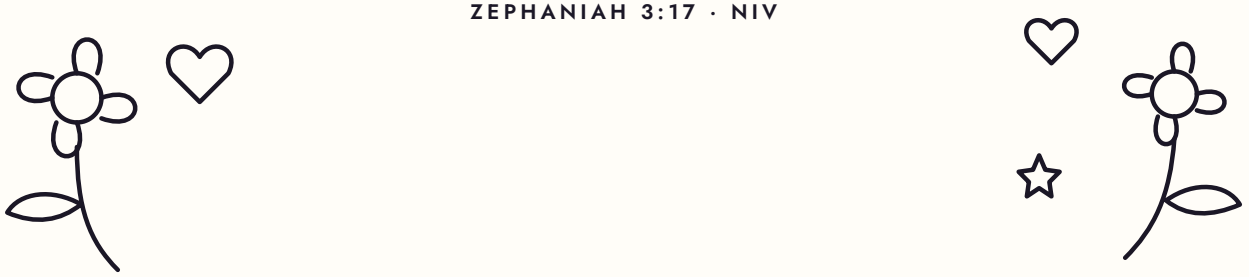




He will take great *delight* in you

...will rejoice over you with singing.

ZEPHANIAH 3:17 · NIV



Margin Notes

COLOR IT · WRITE IT · KEEP IT

The face I imagine when God looks at me:

What He is actually singing over me today:

LOVED THIS? THERE'S MORE WHERE IT CAME FROM

One Sunday a month.

Sunshine Mail is a free monthly letter from Amy Grace: a Bible passage, an honest reflection, and something small to carry into your day.

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it's free.

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